

# COMPLIANCE LAUNCH MATRIX — PUNCH LIST

A per-SKU compliance database: ten required answers before any product exists in the store. Build deferred — this list defines it.

Prepared by Horsepower AI · July 2026 · Companion to the Working Brief v2 — horsepower-hub.vercel.app/gfto-store/

The governing rule: no SKU enters Shopify until its matrix row is 10-for-10 complete.

## A — DESIGN THE MATRIX (BEFORE ANY DATA COLLECTION)

- ☐ **1. Schema locked** — one record per SKU × the ten requirements below; each field holds the answer, the evidence link, who signed it, and the date. *Done when: field list approved.*
- ☐ **2. Sign-off authority named per field** — legal signs classification/claims; finance signs processor; ops signs COA/label. *Done when: one name per column.*
- ☐ **3. The gate wired into process** — "matrix row complete" becomes a formal precondition of the G1 build gate; a SKU with any open cell cannot be created in Shopify. *Done when: rule adopted in writing.*

## B — FILL THE MATRIX: TEN ANSWERS PER SKU

- ☐ **4. Product classification** — supplement, food, cosmetic, pet product, or other. Do this first: it decides which rulebook every other row follows. *Done when: written ruling per SKU.*
- ☐ **5. Approved claims** — the exact language allowed, word for word. *Done when: approved phrase bank per SKU.*
- ☐ **6. Prohibited claims** — the exact language that cannot be used. This pair becomes the AI content engine's claims guardrail — the automation literally reads this table. *Done when: banned phrase list per SKU.*
- ☐ **7. Evidence** — documentation supporting each approved claim, filed and linked. *Done when: every approved claim has a citation attached.*
- ☐ **8. Processor eligibility** — written approval per SKU, not per store. *Done when: processor's answer on file.*
- ☐ **9. Shipping restrictions** — states or destinations excluded per SKU. *Done when: exclusion list loaded (later enforced at checkout).*
- ☐ **10. Subscription approval** — recurring billing explicitly allowed for this product category. *Done when: written confirmation.*
- ☐ **11. Advertising restrictions** — Meta, Google, email, SMS, and affiliate limitations per SKU. Feeds the messaging-lane assignments. *Done when: per-channel yes/no/conditions row complete.*
- ☐ **12. COA status** — current, accessible, product-matched, expiry date recorded. *Done when: live COA linked per batch.*
- ☐ **13. Label status** — reviewed and approved. *Done when: signed label file attached.*

## C — KEEP IT ALIVE (WHY IT'S A DATABASE, NOT A SPREADSHEET)

- **14. Re-verification cadence** — COAs expire, processors change rules, and the federal hemp provisions take effect November 12, 2026; every row gets a review date and an owner. *Done when: cadence set per field type.*
- **15. Change protocol** — when a regulation or processor policy changes, defined rows reopen automatically. *Done when: trigger list written.*

## D — THE BUILD (DEFERRED — SCOPED ONLY)

- **16. Database + simple UI** — the Policy Tracker pattern: Vercel + database, Claude-operable API.
- **17. Evidence file storage** with links from each cell.
- **18. Shopify sync** — matrix status as a product tag; incomplete = product stays in draft.
- **19. Dashboard integration** — matrix completeness per SKU on the Monday summary; alerts on expiring COAs and the Nov 12 deadline.

**Architecture note:** this matrix and the SKU Contribution-Margin Model belong in the same database behind the KPI dashboard — one system of record where compliance status, real margins, and sales all live, all AI-operable. One build project, not two.